

Develop *Interactive* Web Pages *with Ease*

Here's introducing JQuery, arguably the fastest, most concise and elegant JavaScript framework with support for flexible selectors, CSS3, object detection, method chaining, AJAX, plug-ins and UI effects.

In recent years, many social networking sites and content management systems have cropped up to help people keep in touch with each other. Innumerable applications have been given a Web interface, since users of the applications are comfortable accessing them through a Web browser. With Web 2.0, the areas of interaction design and usability have gone through many developments.

The development of a Web 2.0-enabled application has two aspects—delivering function-rich user interfaces and minimising the efforts spent implementing these common features in applications and websites. The main component of any Web 2.0 application is JavaScript. Till a few years back, JavaScript was considered to be ideal for preliminary functions like client side input validation and form submission. Nowadays, most Web applications get most of their logic-related functions done using JavaScript. Features like validation and auto-suggestion are no longer add-ons—they have become very much part of the basic requirements. There is a paradigm shift, both in user interface technologies and the way JavaScript is used.

Anyone who has worked on Web application development would have faced enormous issues due to the diversity in standards across the JavaScript engines used in different browsers. We will discuss some of the most challenging aspects:

1. Browser quirks
2. Maintenance of code
3. Tougher implementation of richer client applications

Browser quirks

As we know, not all browsers follow W3C standards. As usual, Microsoft Internet Explorer (IE) likes to live in its

own isolated world, and what's worse is that different versions of IE behave differently. I'm sure you must have developed a killer function using JavaScript, only to find that it completely failed to work in one of the browsers. Things like selection of a value from a select box, event handling, implementing asynchronous calls, etc, are different across browsers. Likewise, having browser-specific code in applications is not really a good idea.

